

Performance Max: Upgrade and uplift experiments

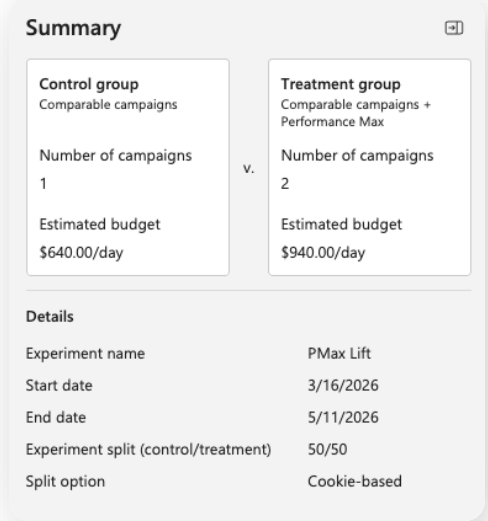
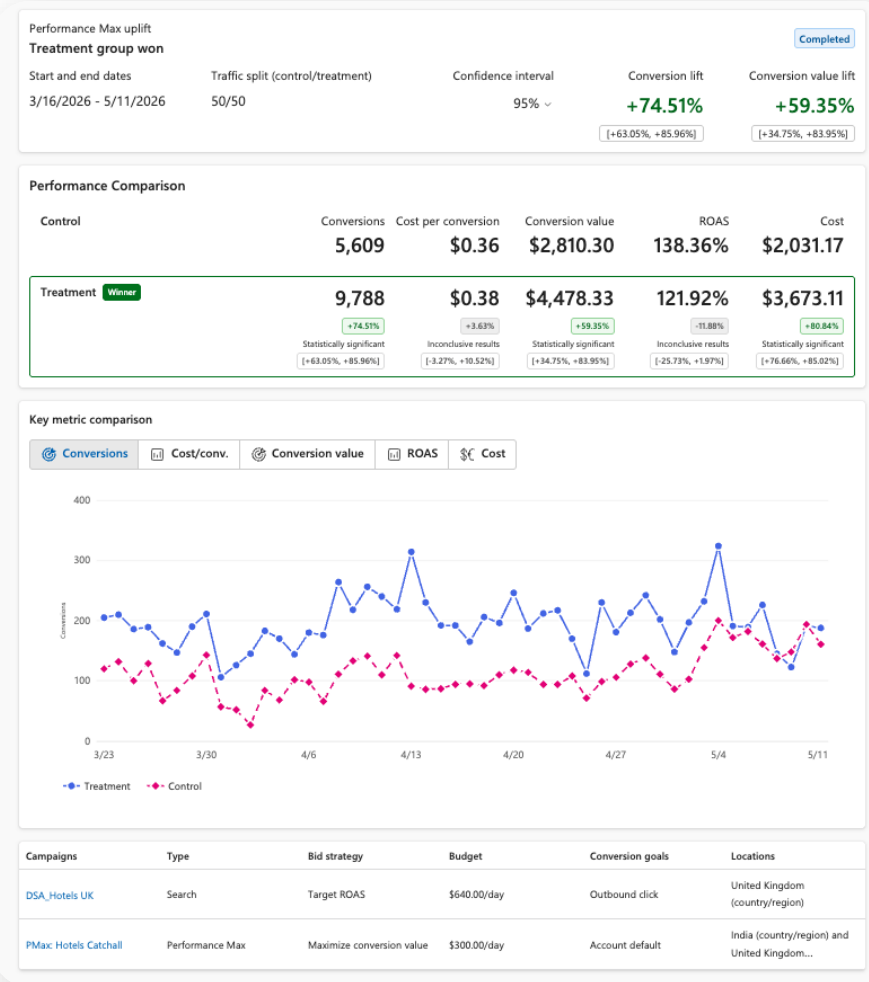
Feature guide

 Microsoft Advertising



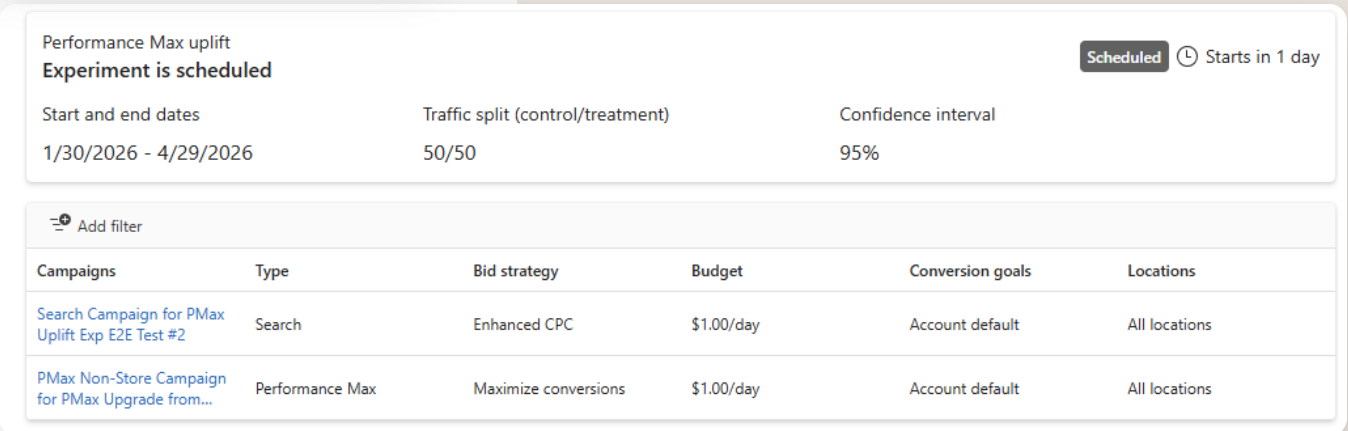
Performance Max: Upgrade and uplift experiments

Get confidence to scale Performance Max investment based on measured results



Compare Performance Max against non-PMax campaigns, helping answer practical questions such as whether to upgrade a campaign to PMax or what uplift in performance PMax adds beyond an existing setup.

Get clear visibility into performance lift from Performance Max and confidence when upgrading or consolidating campaigns.



Product availability

PERFORMANCE MAX EXPERIMENTS	STATUS	MARKETS	ENTRY POINTS	DEVICE	TRAFFIC
	Open beta for PMax campaigns only Internal form for requests to GMI here	NA, LATAM, EMEA, APAC	Online, MAE, API	All devices	Microsoft Advertising Network

Help documentation:

[Create an Upgrade experiment for Performance Max](#)

[Create an Uplift experiment for Performance Max](#)

Note on SLAs:

- **One week** for response to initial experiment request
- Once experiment is over, **one week** for result analysis and recommendations.

Measurement approaches overview

Upgrade / uplift experiments vs. conversion lift summary

PMax Upgrade and Uplift Experiments are tactical, campaign-focused tools designed for faster execution and repeatable decision-making. Conversion lift tests are more strategic, complex, and best suited for long-term channel and budget planning.

	Upgrade / uplift experiments	Conversion lift
What it does	Compare performance of a new PMax campaign, either compared to another campaign or when run alongside other campaigns, asking “Is Performance Max performing better than what we’re running today?”	Measures incrementality by comparing treatment (exposed) vs control (suppressed) users for 6+ week period for your eligible campaigns, asking “what happens if we <i>don’t</i> run these ads? Is this incremental, would these conversions have happened anyway?”
Available campaigns for pilot	PMax (vs. search, shopping, audience)	PMax, search, shopping
Setup complexity and runtime	Low-medium – Minimal setup, No geo splits or holdouts required Recommended duration is 8 weeks	High - Requires complex setup, learning period, often 6-8 weeks before results start to become potentially usable Less control over experiment design than geo tests
Cost and scale required	Moderate - Lower spend requirement than conversion lift, works for mid-size advertisers and doesn’t require massive geo scale	High - requires large spend and large enough audience to split, not always available for small accounts or low-volume conversion actions
Use when:	You want to compare two sets of campaign setups You want a directional, low-risk test to evaluate potential change You need fast answers Spend or volume may be limited	Incrementality is the core question You’re evaluating net-new demand You’re making budget and channel mix decisions Validating long-term value

Upgrade and uplift experiments overview



Upgrade experiments for PMax

Simulate shifting your budget from an existing campaign, like regular Search, Shopping, or Audience ads) into Performance Max campaign. This lets you view how Performance Max might perform compared to your current campaigns before fully committing.

Treatment: 1 PMax campaign

Control: 1 NonPMax campaign (Search, Shopping, Audience)

Experiment split: Randomized user-based, traffic split is variable

Delivery considerations: Both campaigns are eligible for only a portion of traffic during the test, which may temporarily reduce spend. Full traffic is restored after the experiment.

Measurement approach: User-level comparison assessing relative performance lift.

Primary performance metric: Conversions or Conversion value; CPA or ROAS

Recommended duration: Approximately 8 weeks.

Outcome: If the PMax campaign shows statistically significant increase in Conversions without an increase in cost efficiency, then run the PMax campaign **instead of** the NonPmax campaign.

When to use: Direct upgrades, early PMax adoption, and scenarios requiring lower operational complexity.



Uplift experiments for PMax

Measure the conversion or conversion value uplift that Performance Max campaigns can provide when added as a complement to other campaign types (like Search, Shopping, or Audience ads).

Treatment: 1 PMax campaign + Set of comparable NonPMax campaigns (Search, Shopping, Audience)

Control: Same set of comparable NonPMax campaigns

Experiment split: Fixed 50/50 traffic split

Delivery considerations: PMax is eligible for 50% of user traffic during the test, which may temporarily reduce spend. Delivery typically normalizes after completion.

Measurement approach: Isolates performance beyond what existing campaigns achieve on their own.

Primary performance metric: Conversions or Conversion value; CPA or ROAS

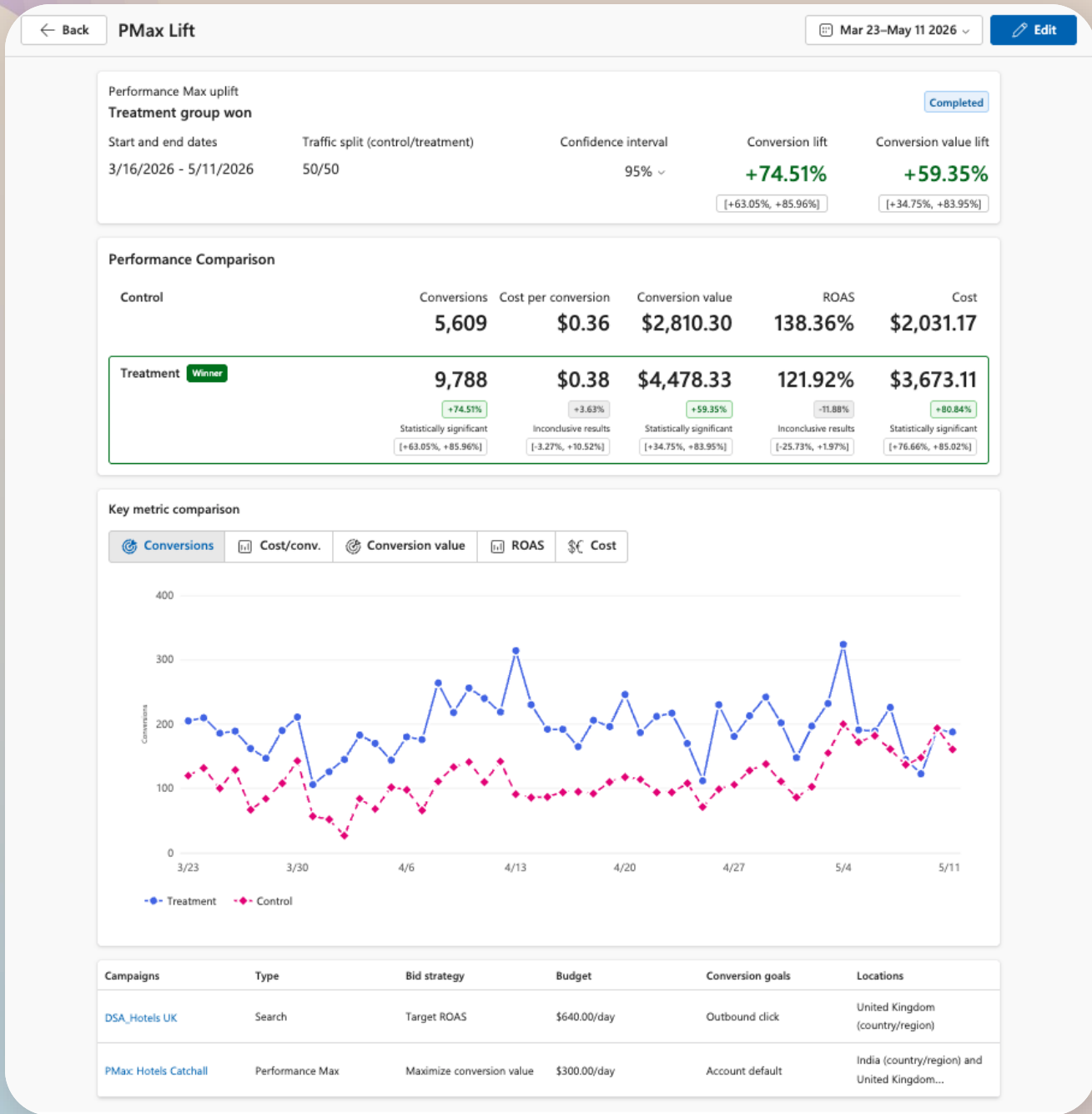
Recommended duration: Approximately 8 weeks.

Outcome: If the Treatment group shows statistically significant lift in Conversions without an increase in cost efficiency, then run the PMax campaign **in addition to the set** of comparable NonPMax campaigns.

When to use: Consolidation, budget reallocation, and scaling decisions.

Reporting example

Results are available in the Microsoft Advertising UI. Reporting focuses on performance lift, and Microsoft Advertising provides support on interpretation and next steps



Setup

Setup steps:

1. Navigate to Campaigns
→ Experiments → Create
2. Choose Performance Max upgrade or uplift experiment
3. Select participating campaigns
4. Set experiment name and dates
5. Launch the experiment

Create Uplift experiment

✓

Experiment details

Performance Max treatment campaign

Choose Performance Max campaign

Comparable campaigns (control and treatment groups)

Choose comparable campaigns

Details

Start date *

Select a date

End date *

Select a date

Experiment name *

Experiment name

Back

Create

Cancel

Setup steps:

1. Navigate to Campaigns
→ Experiments → Create
2. Choose Performance Max upgrade or uplift experiment
3. Select participating campaigns
4. Set experiment name and dates
5. Launch the experiment

Edit PMax Lift

Experiment details

Performance Max treatment campaign

PMax: Hotels Catchall

Budget

Bid strategy

Conversion goals

Locations

\$300.00/day

Maximize conversion value

Unassigned

India (country/region) and United Kingdom (country/region)

Change Performance Max campaign

Comparable campaigns (control and treatment groups)

Campaign (1)	Budget	Bid strategy	Conversion goals	Locations
DSA_Hotels UK	\$640.00/day	Target ROAS	Outbound click	United Kingdom (country/region)

Change comparable campaigns

Details

Start date *

3/16/2026

End date *

5/11/2026

Experiment name *

PMax Lift

Save

Cancel

Summary

Control group		Treatment group
Comparable campaigns		Comparable campaigns + Performance Max
Number of campaigns	1	2
Estimated budget	\$640.00/day	\$940.00/day

Details

Experiment name	PMax Lift
Start date	3/16/2026
End date	5/11/2026
Experiment split (control/treatment)	50/50
Split option	Cookie-based

What to know when first setting up PMax experiments

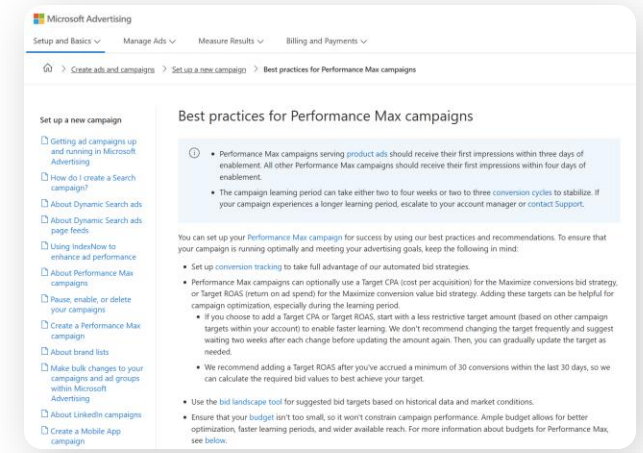
Your Performance Max and non-Performance Max campaign in the experiment should:

1. Belong to the same account
2. Overlap in audience targeting and conversion goals
3. Have comparable average daily spend and performance objectives
4. Demonstrate sufficient historical volume (100+ conversions in a typical 7-day window).

Once your experiment starts:

Keep in mind that *you're splitting up traffic*, so delivery and performance may be affected as you move from 100% to 50% traffic exposure for the PMax campaign.

See additional detail here about best practices: [Best practices for Performance Max campaigns](#)



FAQs

Frequently Asked Questions

Question: Will spend or delivery change during the experiment?

Answer: Yes. Temporary changes are expected and intentional. Campaign eligibility is limited to a portion of traffic during the test to support fair, controlled measurement. Spend and delivery typically normalize once the experiment ends.

Question: How does traffic allocation work by experiment type?

Answer: Upgrade Experiment: Both PMax and Non-PMax campaigns are eligible for only a portion of traffic, which may temporarily reduce spend for both. Uplift Experiment: PMax is eligible for 50% of user traffic, while Non-PMax campaigns serve the remaining 50%.

Question: Is the traffic split permanent?

Answer: No. Traffic allocation applies only during the experiment window. Full eligibility is restored once the experiment concludes and spend should normalize.

Question: Does this require geo splits or ad suppression?

Answer: No. Traffic is split at the user level, with no geo targeting changes or ad suppression required.

Question: What do Upgrade/uplift experiments not do?

Answer: They are not a replacement for strategic incrementality testing, geo-based experiments or ad suppression tests, or creative-only or bid-only A/B tests.



Thank you